

Exactly. The casinos won't bother you if you are doing that. I wore the receiver and sat at the far end of the table, where I couldn't even see the wheel.

So you heard the tones.

Yes, I heard the tones. I had a little speaker . . . [A loud timer tone goes off on Thorp's desk—I swear I am not making the timing of this up.] Whoops, that's the lunch warning. [Thorp had made lunch reservations and set the timer as a reminder.] The speaker was small enough to push into your ear canal. Initially, we had tried copper wires that were as thin as hairs, but they had almost no tensile strength and would break far too easily. We found steel wires that we used, which had a moderate amount of tensile strength, but still not enough, and they also broke periodically. Inevitably, one of the wires would break, and then we would have to leave the roulette table and do a lot of soldering.

How many bets could you get off before the wires broke?

About 12 to 15, and then something would go wrong.

How would Shannon know that something was wrong?

I would just get up and leave the table. One time I was sitting next to the wheel, and there was a lady sitting next to me. Suddenly, she looked at me, and her eyes popped wide open. She was just horror stricken. I knew something was wrong. So I left immediately and went to the men's room. There was a big, black thing, which looked like an insect, coming out of my ear—it was the speaker with wires. The wires were painted with flesh colored nail polish, so they couldn't be seen.

How did that week turn out?

We turned single dimes into piles of dimes.

With a 44 percent edge, why did you use such a conservative bet size?

We wanted to prove that our strategy worked. Also, we were having a lot of trouble with the equipment.

What did your actual edge turn out to be?

It seemed to be consistent with our calculation.